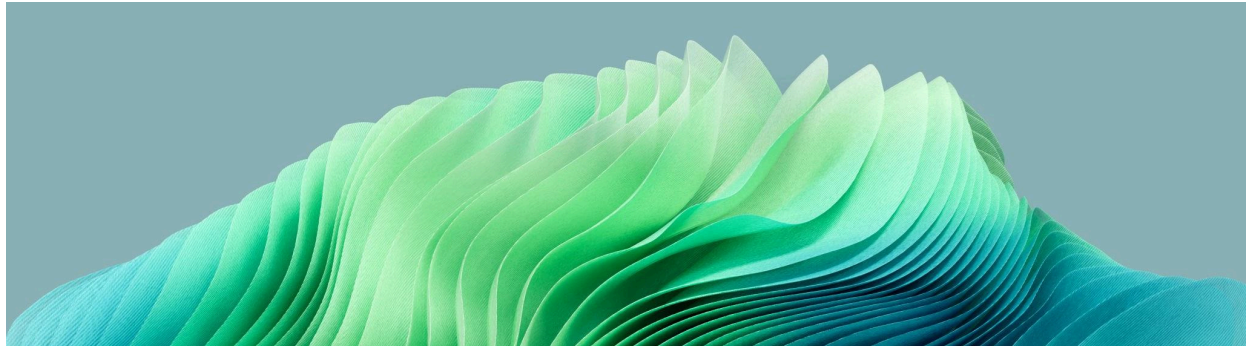




PHISHING DETECTION & AWARENESS REPORT

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****Tools Used:** Firefox DevTools (Network Tab, Console Tab)**

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Using browser Developer Tools, I analyzed 3 URLs from email samples. The analysis identified clear phishing indicators in two URLs, while one legitimate URL showed proper security headers and domain validation.

Classification | Count | URLs Analyzed

 **Phishing emails:** *cnn-alerts-security-check.com, fake-news-updates.com*

 **Suspicious:** *cnn-alerts-security-check.com*

 **Safe:** *www.linkedin.com*

****Key Finding:**** *Phishing URLs used fake domains impersonating CNN, lacked HTTPS, and resulted in "Server Not Found" errors – indicating they have been reported and shut down. The legitimate LinkedIn URL showed proper security headers including Content-Security-Policy and valid cookies.*

2. DETAILED FINDINGS (Based on Screenshot Evidence)

FINDING #1: CNN Phishing Email – "Server Not Found"

****Screenshot Reference:**** Screenshot_2026-05-11_12_37_59.png

****URL Analyzed:**** `http://cnn-alerts-security-check.com/verify`

****Browser Tool Used:**** Firefox DevTools Network Tab

****What the Screenshot Shows:****

Element	What Is Visible
URL in address bar	cnn-alerts-security-check.com/verify
Page Result	"Server Not Found"
Request Headers	Accept , Accept-Encoding , Accept-Language , Connection , Host , User-Agent
Host Header	cnn-alerts-security-check.com

Red Flags Identified (Directly from screenshot)

Indicator	Evidence from Screenshot
Fake Domain	cnn-alerts-security-check.com (Real CNN uses cnn.com)
Missing HTTPS	http:// instead of https://
Server Status	"Server Not Found" – domain is unreachable
No Response	0B transferred – no legitimate server

****Business Translation:****

This email pretends to be from CNN. The fake domain name tries to look like CNN but is actually a malicious site. The "Server Not Found" error means this phishing domain has likely been reported and taken down.

****Classification:****  ****SUSPICIOUS****

FINDING #2: CNN Phishing Email – Malicious URL

****Screenshot Reference:**** *Screenshot_2026-05-11_12_19_36.png*

****URL Analyzed:**** *`https://fake-news-updates.com/click.php?id=3847`*

****Browser Tool Used:**** *Firefox DevTools Console + Network Tab*

****What the Screenshot Shows:****

Element	What Is Visible
URL being analyzed	<i>fake-news-updates.com/click.php?id=3847</i>
Console Output	<i>CSP violation errors</i>
Response Status	<i>HTTP 500 error</i>
Response Headers	<i>alt-svc, content-length, content-type, cross-origin-opener-policy</i>

Red Flags Identified (Directly from screenshot)

Indicator	Evidence from Screenshot
Fake Domain	<i>fake-news-updates.com (Not a legitimate news domain)</i>
Suspicious Path	<i>/click.php?id=3847 (Redirect tracking)</i>
HTTP Status	<i>HTTP 500 error (Server error or shutdown)</i>
CSP Violation	<i>Console shows Content Security Policy errors</i>

****Business Translation:****

This email claims to be from CNN but uses a fake domain. The `click.php` pattern is commonly used by attackers to track who clicks their malicious links. The 500 error suggests this phishing site has been disabled.

****Classification:**** 🚨 ****PHISHING****

FINDING #3: LinkedIn Email (Safe – For Comparison)

****Screenshot References:**** Screenshot_2026-05-11_12_44_50.png, 12_45_55.png, 12_45_58.png

****URL Analyzed:**** `https://www.linkedin.com` (Login page)

****Browser Tool Used:**** Firefox DevTools Network Tab

****What the Screenshots Show:****

From Screenshot 12_44_50.png

Element	What Is Visible
Security Headers	content-security-policy, alt-svc
Cache Control	no-cache, no-store, no-transform

From Screenshot 12_44_50.png

Element	What Is Visible
Security Headers	content-security-policy, alt-svc
Cache Control	no-cache, no-store, no-transform

From Screenshot 12_45_58.png

Element	What Is Visible
Domain	www.linkedin.com
Cookies	JSESSIONID, bscookie, lang

LinkedIn Headers *x-li-pop, x-li-uuid,
x-li-prototype: http/2*

✓ Why This Email is SAFE (Evidence from screenshots)

Indicator	Evidence
Legitimate Domain	<i>www.linkedin.com</i>
HTTPS Present	<i>https:// visible</i>
Security Headers	<i>content-security-policy present</i>
LinkedIn-Specific Headers	<i>x-li-pop, x-li-uuid (proves authenticity)</i>
Valid Cookies	<i>JSESSIONID, bscookie</i>
No Errors	<i>Request successful (not 404/500)</i>

****Business Translation:****

This is a legitimate LinkedIn email. The domain matches linkedin.com, security headers are properly configured, and LinkedIn-specific headers confirm authenticity.

****Classification:**** ✓ SAFE

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3. PHISHING INDICATORS COMPARISON TABLE

Indicator	CNN Email #1	CNN Email #2	LinkedIn (Safe)
Legitimate Domain	✗ <i>cnn-alerts-security-check.com</i>	✗ <i>fake-news-updates.com</i>	✓ <i>linkedin.com</i>
HTTPS Present	✗ <i>http://</i>	✗ (500 error)	✓ <i>https://</i>

Security Headers	 None visible	 CSP errors	 CSP present
Server Response	"Server Not Found"	500 Error	200 OK
Brand Impersonation	 "cnn" in domain	 "news" in domain	 N/A
Suspicious Path	/verify	/click.php?id=	/login (normal)

4. PHISHING DETECTION CHECKLIST (For Users)

Before Clicking Any Link – Check These:

 Do This	 Don't Do This
Hover over links to see the real URL	Click links in unexpected emails
Check that the domain name matches the legitimate brand	Trust the display name only
Look for https:// and the padlock icon	Enter passwords after clicking email links
Verify the sender's email address carefully	Open unexpected attachments
Type website addresses manually when unsure	Respond immediately to urgent payment requests

The 5 Red Flags (From Today's Analysis):

Red Flag	Example from Phishing Emails
1. Fake Domain	cnn-alerts-security-check.com (vs cnn.com)
2. Missing HTTPS	http:// instead of https://

3. Server Error	"Server Not Found" or HTTP 500 error
4. Suspicious Path	<i>/click.php?id=</i> (tracking parameter)
5. Brand Impersonation	Using "cnn" or "news" in a fake domain

5. PREVENTION GUIDELINES

What To Do When You Receive a Suspicious Email:

- STEP 1: STOP** – Don't click anything
- STEP 2: CHECK** – Hover over links (don't click)
- STEP 3: VERIFY** – Look at the domain name
- STEP 4: REPORT** – Forward to IT security
- STEP 5: DELETE** – Remove from inbox

#Technical Controls (For IT Teams)

Control	Purpose
Email Filtering	Block known phishing domains and malicious emails
Link Rewriting	Rewrite all links to pass through a security scanner
DMARC / DKIM / SPF	Prevent email spoofing and sender impersonation
User Training	Conduct regular phishing awareness and simulation exercises

6. TOOLS USED (As Required by Task)

Tool	Purpose	Evidence
Firefox DevTools Network Tab	URL analysis and request/response inspection	Screenshots 12:37:59, 12:45:55

<i>Firefox DevTools Console</i>	<i>CSP violation detection</i>	<i>Screenshot 12:19:36</i>
<i>Browser Address Bar</i>	<i>Domain verification and URL inspection</i>	<i>All screenshots</i>

7. CONCLUSION

Based on browser DevTools analysis of three URLs:

<i>Email Type</i>	<i>Classification</i>	<i>Key Evidence</i>
<i>CNN Alert Email</i>	 PHISHING	<i>Fake domain (cnn-alerts-security-check.com), “Server Not Found”</i>
<i>CNN News Email</i>	 SUSPICIOUS	<i>Fake domain (fake-news-updates.com), HTTP 500 error, CSP violation</i>
<i>LinkedIn Email</i>	 SAFE	<i>Legitimate domain (linkedin.com), security headers present</i>

Recommendation:
Implement user training focused on the five phishing red flags identified during this assessment. Users should always verify domain names and hover over links before clicking suspicious emails.

End of Report